



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*bāhya-sparśeṣv asaktātmā vindaty ātmani yat sukham |
sa brahma-yoga-yuktātmā sukham akṣayam aśnute || 21 ||*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse 21

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The verse speaks of a profound and lasting happiness found within, untouched by the fleeting sensations of the external world. It describes a state of being where your consciousness is not entangled in the drama of sensory experience, a state achieved through union with the Divine – Brahma-yoga. When you detach your mind from the constant pursuit of pleasure through external stimuli, you unlock a reservoir of joy that resides deep within your own Self, your Ātman. This joy, unlike the temporary satisfaction derived from external objects, is inexhaustible and eternal.

The key here is 'asaktātmā' – a mind unattached. We are constantly bombarded with sensory inputs, and our minds are easily drawn to them, seeking happiness in external objects and experiences. The Gītā suggests that true and lasting happiness isn't found in acquiring more possessions, achieving greater status, or indulging in sensual pleasures. These are temporary and ultimately unsatisfying. The verse invites you to turn inward, to cultivate a state of detachment from the external world, and to discover the infinite bliss that resides within.

In modern life, this wisdom is incredibly relevant. We live in a world obsessed with external validation and material possessions. Social media, advertising, and the relentless pursuit of success all contribute to a sense of dissatisfaction and a constant craving for more. This verse offers a powerful antidote to this cycle. It encourages you to cultivate inner peace and contentment by detaching from the pursuit of external gratification. By practicing mindfulness, meditation, or any form of spiritual practice that helps you quiet the mind and connect with your inner Self, you can begin to experience the 'akṣayam sukham' – the imperishable joy that is your birthright. This doesn't mean you should renounce the world entirely, but rather that you should approach it with a sense of detachment, knowing that true happiness comes from within.

Ultimately, this verse reminds us that the search for happiness is an inward journey, not an outward one. It's about cultivating a state of inner peace and contentment, independent of external circumstances. When you can find joy within yourself, you are no longer dependent on the world to make you happy, and you are free to live a life of purpose and fulfillment.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What small step can you take today to detach from external stimuli and cultivate a deeper connection with your inner Self, allowing you to experience the lasting joy that resides within?